

Skills Summary

Missing and Mixed-Up Numbers

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Counting Forward One at a Time

The next number is always one more.

- Say the number just before the blank, then say the next number out loud.
- Check the other way too: the missing number is one less than the number after the blank.
- Counting order: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

Example: What is missing? 7 8 ____ 10

Step 1. Put a finger on the number just before the blank and say it out loud.

Step 2. After 8 comes **9**, and 9 is also one less than 10, so both checks agree.

Try it: What is missing? 3 4 ____ 6

check: 5

Skill 2 — Finding a Number That Was Skipped

Count the row out loud and stop at the first number that surprises you.

- Touch one finger to each numeral as you say it. Skipping is easier to hear than to see.
- A number can also be in the wrong place. Then nothing is missing, but the row still does not match your counting.
- Write the row again the right way, all the way to the end.

Example: Which number was skipped? 12 13 15 16

Step 1. Count the row out loud and listen for the place where the next word does not match.

Step 2. After 13 you should say **14**, so 14 is the number that was skipped.

Try it: Which number was skipped? 5 6 8 9

check: 7

Skill 3 — Which Number Is Bigger

The number you say later when counting is the bigger number.

- Start at the smaller-looking one and count up. If you reach the other number, that one is bigger.
- Watch the flipped pairs: 12 and 21 use the same digits, and only counting tells them apart.

Example: Which is bigger, 14 or 9?

Step 1. Start at the smaller-looking number and count up out loud.

Step 2. Counting from 9 you reach 14 later, so **14 > 9**.

Try it: Which is bigger, 18 or 11?

check: $11 < 18$